

Adjunct

Adjunct is any adverb, adverbial clause, adverbial phrase or prepositional phrase that adds extra meaning/information to a sentence thus, if Adjunct is removed from a sentence, the sentence will still remain grammatically correct. Hence, adjunct is not an essential part of a sentence but are there to make it more meaningful. Specifically, Adjuncts are usually adverbs used to modify verbs, another adverb or even a complement.

Adjuncts when used as an adverb will usually indicate time, place, reason, frequency, manner or degree of action.

Example;

1. Ada slapped Ike in the gallery (place)
2. My sister travelled to Abuja yesterday (time)
3. He screamed angrily (manner)

In the examples stated above, the three sentences are still complete even without the underlined part.

Adverbial is different from Adjunct in that, Adjunct is a type of Adverbial which add OPTIONAL information to a sentence while Adverbials add information that are RELEVANT to the overall meaning of a sentence.

Example;

1. I put my bag on the floor = Adverbial
2. I dropped my bag next to my seat and sat down = Adjunct

In the instances above, one will observe that the first sentence is incomplete without the extra information whereas, in the second sentence, the underlined information is not necessary in making the sentence complete thus it is a complete sentence even without the underlined aspect.

- I put my bag (incomplete sentence). Thus, the Adverbial adds information relevant in making the sentence to be complete and meaningful.
- I dropped my bag and sat down. (Complete sentence). Here, the sentence can stand with or without the underlined information

Types of Adjuncts

1. Adjunct of Time

Example; we shall meet after the break.

In the morning I will cross the bridge.

The alarm went off yesterday.

2. Adjunct of Place

Example; Mr. Smith is having his leisure in the stadium.

Thompson's car is packed at the garage.

Mum is relaxing outside the house.

Ere, the situation is completely different.

3. Adjunct of Manner

Example; the news of his demise came as a thunderbolt.

I travelled to Lagos in Obedience.

She handled the case carefully.

4. Adjunct of Frequency or Degree

Example; he comes to school always.

He seldom visits his grandmother

We occasionally travel together.

5. Adjunct of Reason

Example; he did it for God's sake.

The little boy came to the field to play football.

They were flogged because they fought.

As its Friday, you can stay up another hour.

6. Adjunct of Degree: the structure (as + adverb + as) is used to express that two persons or things are equal or not equal in degree or intensity

Example: you are not as poor as you could have been.

She is as smart as she is brilliant.